

Wen Xuan CHIOK (Shane) Terrestrial Ecologist | Green Mark AP | National Geographic ExplorerEmail: chiokwenxuan@gmail.com • [GScholar](#) / [RGate](#) / [LinkedIn](#)**Professional Summary**

I am a conservation biologist and project manager with over seven years of experience in field ecology, wildlife trade research, and environmental consulting across Southeast Asia. As a researcher, I have led studies on Southeast Asian vertebrate conservation, with first-author publications in *Bird Conservation International* and co-authorships in *Ecology* and *Conservation Science and Practice*. As a 2020 National Geographic Explorer, I led fieldwork and investigations into the transboundary bird trade between Singapore and the wider region.

In my consultancy career, I have managed environmental permitting, EIA, and environmental monitoring projects up to SGD\$2M, including environmental and social due diligence work across Singapore and Southeast Asia. I have established working relationships with government agencies and NGOs including WCS-Singapore and TRAFFIC SEA through joint research and consultancy work.

Currently, I am pursuing a MSc in Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainability at NUS in August 2026, supported by a full scholarship from the Loke Cheng-Kim Foundation.

Professional Interests — Tropical wildlife ecology and conservation • Sustainable landscape design & architecture • Land-use planning • Habitat restoration & mitigation • Spatial/Ecological modelling

Education

M.Sc. (in progress) Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainability, National University of Singapore [Loke Cheng Kim Foundation Postgraduate Scholar]	2026 – 2027
B.Sc. (Hons.) Environmental Biology—Aquatic Ecology Minor, National University of Singapore	2015 – 2019
B.Sc. (Exchange program), Ecological Sciences, University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom	2017 – 2018

Conservation & Research Outputs ([†]Research assistants/consultants who worked with me)*Publications & Technical Reports*

Thomas, N.J., Baker, N.R., Fung, T.K., Chiok, W.X. & Teo, R.C.H. (2026). Updated inventory of amphibians, reptiles and mammals of Pulau Ubin, Singapore. In National Parks Board. (2026). An Update of the Biodiversity in Pulau Ubin, Singapore (pp.375-387).	2026
Ong, J. M., Khoo, M.D. Y., Tay, L.S., Lim, B.T.M., Chiok, W.X. , Png, K.G.C., Marsh, C.J., Tan, M.A.S., Niissalo, M.A., Khew, G.S.W., Chua, M.A.H., Soh, M.C. K., Luskin, M.S. & Lim, J.Y. (2026) Land use legacies shape wild boar (<i>Sus scrofa</i>) diet along a forest-urban gradient in Singapore. <i>Urban Ecology</i> .	2026
Chiok, W.X. , Ang, A., Sankar, A., Sin, Y.C.K., Jain, A., Kannan, R., Law, I.S., Law, I.T., Movin, N., Shivaram, R., Tan, H.Z., Woo, H.P.M., & Xu, W. (2024). Terrestrial Vertebrates. In A. Sankar & A. Ang (Eds.), Singapore Terrestrial Conservation Plan (pp.54-101). Singapore Terrestrial Conservation Plan Committee.	2024
Mendes, C. P., Chiok, W. X. , Zainuddin, Z. Z. & Luskin, M. S. (2024). CamTrapAsia: a dataset of tropical forest vertebrate communities from 239 camera trapping studies . <i>Journal of Ecology</i> 105(6):e4299.	2024
Lamperty, T., Chiok, W. X. , Wardle, D. A. & Luskin, M. S. (2023). Rewilding in Southeast Asia: Singapore as a case study . <i>Conservation Science and Practice</i> 2023;5:e12899.	2023
Chiok W. X. , Luskin, M. S. & Chua, M. A. H. (2022) Biodiversity Record: Mainland leopard cat in Kranji Marshes and Lim Chu Kang . <i>Nature in Singapore</i> , 15: e2022112.	2022
Chiok, W. X. (2022) Caged Melody: Exploring the dynamics of songbird owners in Singapore . <i>Dawn Chorus, Asian Songbird Trade Specialist Group Newsletter</i> 2(2), 23–24.	2022
Yong, C. K. L. Png, K. G. C., Tan, S. K. B., Lee, B. P. Y.-H, Khoo, M. D. Y., Chiok, W. X. , Luskin, M. S. & Wardle, D. A. (2022). Plants associated with wild pig (<i>Sus scrofa</i>) foraging activities in Singapore secondary forests . <i>Suiform Soundings, IUCN SSC Wild Pig Specialist Group</i> , 1–8.	2022
Chiok, W. X. , Lee, R. Y. Y. [†] , Lee, J. G. H. & Jain, A. (2022). The dynamics of songbird ownership and community interconnectedness in Singapore . <i>Bird Conservation International</i> , 1–17.	2022

Chiok, W. X. & Chng, S. C. L. (2021). <i>Trading Faces: Live bird trade on Facebook in Singapore</i> . TRAFFIC Southeast Asia, Petaling Jaya, Malaysia.	2021
Chiok, W. X. , Ng, E. Y. X., Tang, Q., Lee, J. G. H. & Rheindt, F. E. (2020). <i>A distance sampling survey of the Critically Endangered Straw-headed Bulbul <i>Pycnonotus zeylanicus</i> in Singapore</i> . <i>Bird Conservation International</i> , 31(3), 468–480.	2020
Nyanasengeran, M., Yong, D. L. & Chiok, W. X. (2020) <i>Collar & Sykes 10 years on—how birders can help conservation in South-East Asia</i> . <i>BirdingASIA</i> , (34): 59–76.	2020
Chiok, W. X. , Miller, A. E., Pang, S. E. H., Eaton, J. A., Rao, M. & Rheindt, F. E. (2019). <i>Regional extirpations of a formerly common Sundaic rainforest passerine, the Straw-headed Bulbul <i>Pycnonotus zeylanicus</i></i> . <i>Forktail-Journal of Asian Ornithology</i> , (36): 3–11.	2019
Chiok, W. X. (2019). <i>Attempted predation on an octopus by a Malayan water monitor lizard</i> . <i>Nature in Singapore</i> , (2019): 40–41.	2019

Research Grants & Awards

Loke Cheng-Kim Foundation Postgraduate Scholarship Recipient	2026 – 2027
- Full scholarship to undertake the MSc Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainability at NUS	
National Geographic Society Early Career Grant, 2020 Explorer	2020 – 2023
- Principal investigator for research project titled “ <i>Exploring the transboundary bird trade links between Singapore and its neighbours</i> ”	
Wildlife Conservation Society (Singapore) Travel Grant	2019
- Attended a wildlife trade & trafficking skill-building workshop for NGOs & governmental organisations in Bogor, Indonesia	
Wildlife Reserves Singapore Conservation Fund (WRSCF) Research Grant	2018 – 2019
- Principal investigator for research project titled “ <i>Understanding the dynamics of songbird trade in Singapore</i> ”	

Research & Professional Experience

MSc Student-Researcher , MSc in Biodiversity Conservation & Sustainability NUS	Aug 2026 – Jul 2027
- Research Thesis Advisor: Prof. Ryan Chisholm - Theoretical Ecology and Modelling Lab	
Environmental Consultant - Aurecon, Singapore	Oct 2024 – Aug 2026
- DHI Water & Environment, Singapore	Mar 2023 – Sep 2024
- Technical Proficiency – Assessed biodiversity/environmental impacts, identified risks, and proposed mitigation measures (e.g., nature-based solutions, compensatory measures & offsets)	
- Involved in environmental permitting (e.g. EIA/EMMP technical reports) and due diligence projects in Singapore and SEA, including field work	
- Project Management, Monitoring & Evaluation – Successfully managed EIA/EMMP projects (up to SGD\$2mil) as main project manager	
- Including client coordination, team oversight, resource allocation and stakeholder engagement	
- Ensure timely submission of deliverables, while keeping project expenditure within budget, maintaining healthy financials	
Scientist , Biorisk & Biosurveillance, Animal & Veterinary Services, National Parks Board, Singapore	Jun 2022 – Feb 2023
- Conducted research on zoonotic diseases, analysing their global/local status, epidemiology, public/animal health impacts, and mitigation strategies	
- Produced intelligence briefs by sourcing and synthesizing open-source information on zoonotic disease outbreaks worldwide – developed and conducted horizon scanning efforts	
- Developed technical documents, including risk assessments, reports, guidelines, and preparatory materials	
Project Coordinator-Research Assistant , Forest Ecology Lab—Ecological Cascades Lab, Asian School of the Environment, Prof. David A. Wardle (co-PI), Nanyang Technological University; Asst. Prof. Matthew S. Luskin (co-PI), University of Queensland.	May 2020 – Apr 2022
- Conducted camera trapping, botanical and soil fieldwork for long-term fenced experimental	

plots within tropical forests	
- Contributed to ecological modelling on Singapore's ungulate population demographics	
- Managed and outlined finances for project (SGD\$500k research grant)	
Research Assistant , Theoretical Ecology and Modelling Lab, Assoc. Prof. Ryan Chisholm (PI), NUS	Oct 2019 – May 2020
- Conducted research on avian island biogeography patterns	
- Contributed to modelling on ecological/biogeographical effects on avifaunal diversity and extinction rates	
Research Consultant (Biodiversity) , M'GO Films, Singapore	Jun 2019 – Sep 2019
- Drafted and curated pertinent biodiversity-related content to be developed into info banners for public exhibits	
- Consultant for exhibits: “Forest Discovery Centre” & “Botanical Art Gallery”, at the Gallop Atbara House Extension	
Wildlife Trade Consultant , TRAFFIC, Southeast Asia Headquarters, Malaysia	Nov 2018 – Apr 2019
- Conducted wildlife market surveys in Singapore, and digital investigations into illicit wildlife trade in the Southeast Asian region	
- Lead author on a technical report by TRAFFIC	
Intern , WCS-SG – IUCN SSC Asian Species Action Partnership, Mandai Nature, Singapore	2018
Intern , Wildlife Conservation Society (WCS-SG), Singapore	2017

Academic Memberships & Societies

Explorer , National Geographic Society	2020 – present
Member , IUCN Species Survival Commission Asian Songbird Trade Specialist Group (ASTSG)	2019 – present
Executive Committee Member , Herpetological Society of Singapore	2019 – present
Member (Vertebrate Study Group) , Nature Society Singapore	2018 – present
Member , Malaysian Nature Society	2019 – present
Participant , Singapore Pangolin Working Group	2017 – 2018

Conferences, Symposia & Media Outreach

Newspaper Feature — Wild boars on Pulau Ubin scarcely seen due to suspected swine fever Lianhe Zaobao, Singapore.	Oct 2023
Newspaper Feature — Experts: Excessive culling of local wild boars may be inevitable Lianhe Zaobao, Singapore.	May 2023
Newspaper Feature — Sambar deer making a return in Singapore, study shows The Straits Times, Singapore.	Mar 2023
Newspaper Feature — Wild boars likely to recolonise whole of Singapore in next decade: Study The Straits Times, Singapore.	Feb 2023
Newspaper Feature — African swine fever likely to decimate Singapore's wild boar population: Experts The Straits Times, Singapore.	Feb 2023
News Article — Want a wild bird on the hush-hush in Singapore? There's a Facebook group for that. Mongabay.	Dec 2021
Newspaper Feature — Birds sold in mostly illegal online trade in Singapore may be smuggled, poached: Report. TODAY, Singapore.	Dec 2021
Podcast Discussion — Wild boar attacks in Punggol – averting the next dangerous encounter. Channel News Asia, Singapore.	Mar 2021
Newspaper Feature — Some residents in Thomson tell how they live with brutish wild boars and hungry monkeys. TODAY, Singapore.	Mar 2021
Newspaper Feature — Explainer: How did a wild boar venture into the heart of Punggol housing estate? TODAY, Singapore.	Feb 2021
Newspaper Feature — Critically endangered songbird finds stronghold in Singapore: Study. The Straits Times, Singapore.	Nov 2020
Documentary Consultant (German) — Songbirds, the golden voices of Singapore. ARTE TV, GEO Report, Germany.	2020
Rao, M., Chiok, W. X. , Hamid, S. A. & Nuruliawati, N. “ <i>Songbird declines in Southeast Asia: A summary of conservation status and approaches to tackling demand</i> ”. Side event presentation, CITES CoP18 , Geneva, Switzerland.	2019
Chiok, W. X. “ <i>Status assessment of three traded songbirds in Singapore</i> ”. Oral presentation, IUCN SSC Asian Songbird Trade Specialist Group (ASTSG) Meeting, Singapore.	2019
- Approx. 50 attendees, with international and ASEAN-regional delegates/academics	
Chiok, W. X. “ <i>Understanding songbird owners in Singapore: An exploratory study</i> ”. Oral presentation, Straw-headed Bulbul Conservation Planning Workshop, Singapore.	2019
- Singapore-centric meeting, approx. 50 attendees, with naturalists, researchers & NParks	
Chiok, W. X. “ <i>Understanding the dynamics of songbird trade in Singapore</i> ”. Poster, Wildlife Reserves Singapore Conservation	2019

Fund 10th Anniversary Gala, Singapore.

- WRS' Gala, approx. 200 attendees, with members of the public and private sector

Skills & Expertise

Accreditations and Certifications

Singapore 'Class 3' driver's licence	-	2014
Green Mark Accredited Professional (GM AP)	BCA Singapore	2023
Introduction to Nature-based Carbon Offsets & Blue Carbon	DHI	2023
Wildlife Management in Developments	NParks	2023
Nature-based Solutions for Disaster and Climate Resilience	UN Environment Programme (UNEP)	2023
Integrated Water Resources Management (IWRM) for Climate Resilience	UNEP-DHI	2023
Animal Management (Basic) Professional Certification	NParks	2024
Introduction to Finance for Nature	IUCN Academy	2025
Animal Management (Intermediate) Professional Certification – Mammals	NParks	2025
Fundamentals on REDD+	UN-REDD Programme	2025
Accredited Project Manager	Aurecon	2025
Biodiversity Finance: Designing and Implementing Finance Plans for Nature	UNDP	2025

Computer Literacy

Microsoft Office Suite: Excel • Word • PowerPoint

Adobe Photoshop • Lightroom • Illustrator • MIKE (Basic)

Ecological & Technical Skills

Camera-trapping (Proficient) • Distance sampling • Occupancy analyses • R/RStudio

Questionnaire/survey formulation & execution • Database management • Research ethics/ respondent anonymisation

Mapping and cartographical/Spatial analyses in R • ArcGIS/ArcMap/QGIS • ArcGIS–StoryMap

Southeast Asian avifauna and herpetofauna, including mammals (Proficient) • Southeast Asian flora (Basic)

Languages

English • Mandarin–Chinese (Native language)

..... Bahasa Indonesia (NUS Level 1/Basic) • Bahasa Melayu (Basic)

Academic & Professional References (in no specific order)

Professor Ryan Chisholm

Research Lead (Ecology, Evolution and Biodiversity Group)

Department of Biological Sciences, NUS, Singapore

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Associate Professor Roman Carrasco

Deputy Head of Department (Research)

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Assistant Professor Madhu Rao

Chair, IUCN-WCPA & Director, WCS-SG

Wildlife Conservation Society, Singapore

mrao@wcs.org

Associate Professor Frank E. Rheindt

Dean's Chair; Principal Investigator, Avian Evolution Lab

Department of Biological Sciences, NUS, Singapore

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Assistant Professor Anuj Jain

Preventing Extinctions & Bird Trade Asia Coordinator,

Birdlife International (Asia), Singapore

Founder, bioSEA

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Nature Manager

The Private Infrastructure Development Group (PIDG),

Singapore

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Consultancy – Project Track Records

Track records available upon request.